

WHAT VALUES ARE ACTUALLY “CORE?”

Let's get honest about the values that influence our decisions and determine how we show up when it matters most.



The Core Idea

Most of us can name a leader we deeply admire - someone whose example has shaped the way we think, lead, or carry ourselves. But if you asked ten different people to name what they respect about that person, you'd get ten different answers.

Still, there's one thing each of those examples has in common - they know what they stand for. More importantly, they consistently show up that way, in the small moments and the large ones, regardless of whether it's easy or if it costs them something.

That's what values can do for you. And we want to help you get clear on yours.



Key Ideas:

1. Values aren't just something you believe. They are something you live.

They often show up in the smallest moments when nobody but you would notice if you compromised. These moments are quiet, but quite revealing.

2. Without clear values, it's easy to confuse progress for motion.

Not everything you care about is a core value. Core values are the ones you're willing to sacrifice to uphold. Knowing the difference changes everything.

3. You discover values by looking in the mirror, not out the window.

Pay attention to when you feel most alive and what makes your blood boil. Your values aren't waiting to be discovered - they are already inside you, waiting to be named.

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Reflection Question(s)

1. Think of a leader you deeply admire. What do you think they value most, and how does it show up?
2. When did you last make a decision that reflected your core values, even when it cost you something? How did it feel to make this decision?
3. What personal value are you most confident is a core value? How did you discover this, and what can this teach you about how to discover what else you value?



It's not hard to make decisions when you know what your values are.

Roy Disney



Challenge: Trim Down the List



If you want to go deeper on identifying your personal values, the exercise is simpler than you might think: write down twenty qualities you care about, narrow to ten, then five, then three. What's left is worth paying attention to, and having to make cuts along the way will reveal what truly matters most to you.